VeriGate

Real-Time Risk Intelligence for Africa

Cross-agency verification. AI-powered risk scoring. Conflict of interest detection. Fraud detection. Zero centralised data.

14 Verification Types | 3 AI Modules | 0 Centralised Databases

Prepared for

Fuze

Digital Africa

April 2026

Verification in Africa is broken.

Fragmented Systems

- Onboarding a customer requires checks against **6–10 disconnected agencies** (DHA, CIPC, SARS, SAQA, Deeds Office, credit bureaus, sanctions lists)
- Each agency has its own portal, credentials, data format, and downtime schedule
- A single KYC/KYB check takes **3–5 business days** involving multiple teams

Invisible Corruption

- Conflicts of interest slip through when data lives in **separate silos**
- A procurement officer who is also a director of the bidding company is **invisible** without cross-source correlation
- The Auditor-General flags this as a root cause of irregular expenditure **every year**

THE COST OF THE STATUS QUO

R30B+

LOST ANNUALLY TO IDENTITY & GRANT FRAUD IN SA

R7B+

ANNUAL INSURANCE FRAUD COST

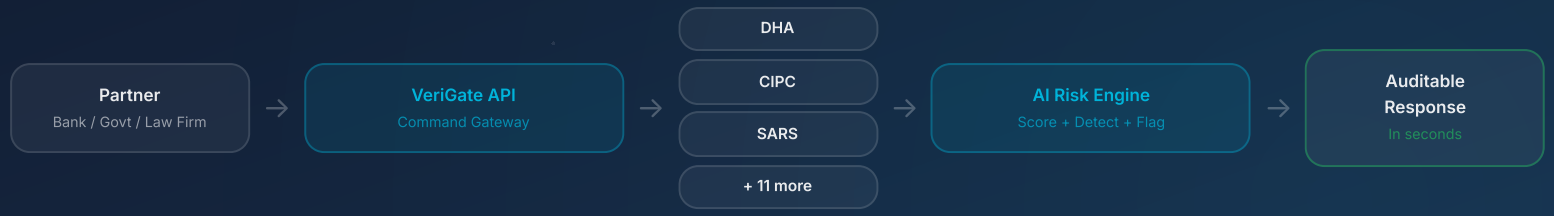
R1B+

BANKS SPEND ON FRAGMENTED KYC/AML COMPLIANCE PER YEAR

> **The root cause is architectural: there is no shared risk intelligence layer that respects data sovereignty while enabling real-time cross-agency verification.**

Sources: National Treasury, SIU, SAIA, SABRIC, Auditor-General reports

One API. 14 sources. Seconds, not days.



RS

Risk Signals Engine

Aggregates results across all sources. Cross-references CIPC directorships, shareholding, property, PEP status, and sanctions to **automatically detect conflicts of interest** and hidden relationships.

FD

Fraud Detector

ML-powered detection of synthetic identities, document tampering, coordinated fraud rings, and multi-party abuse patterns across verification sources.

AI

Bedrock Common

Shared AI infrastructure on AWS Bedrock for document OCR, entity extraction, and natural language processing of unstructured government records.

Data sovereignty by design, not by policy.

Each agency retains full control of its own data. VeriGate orchestrates, never centralises.

Adapter-Based Architecture

Every verification source is a self-contained adapter module. Adding a new country means building adapters for local registries — **not rebuilding the platform**. This is how VeriGate scales across Africa without proportional engineering cost.

Cross-Account AWS Model

Each participating agency gets its own AWS account. VeriGate orchestrates verification across accounts without ever centralising raw data. This is a **hard requirement for government adoption** and extraordinarily difficult to retrofit.

Event-Driven Audit Trail

Every verification is an immutable event — fully auditable, replayable, and analyzable. Meets POPIA, FICA, and NCR compliance requirements.

Technology Stack

BACKEND Java 21 + Spring Boot 3.3	COMPUTE AWS Lambda (Serverless)
AI / ML AWS Bedrock	MESSAGING SQS FIFO + EventBridge
DATABASE DynamoDB (Event Store)	FRONTEND Next.js 15.5 + React 19

Architecture Patterns

Clean Architecture · CQRS · Event-Driven · POPIA-Native · Serverless

05 — FLAGSHIP CAPABILITY

Automated Conflict of Interest Detection

No other platform in Africa cross-references CIPC directorships, shareholding, property, and PEP databases in real time to surface hidden relationships.

EXAMPLE: PROCUREMENT FRAUD DETECTED

JD

John Doe
Procurement Officer, Dept. of Public Works

CONFLICT DETECTED

ABC

ABC Construction (Pty) Ltd
Bidding on R50M government tender

VeriGate detected: John Doe's spouse is a 35% shareholder in ABC Construction. CIPC directorship records + DeedsWeb property co-ownership confirmed shared address. Risk score: **DENY**.

Cross-Referenced Sources

- **CIPC** — Directorships, shareholding percentages, beneficial ownership
- **DeedsWeb** — Property co-ownership, shared addresses
- **Sanctions & PEP** — Politically Exposed Persons, watchlists
- **DHA** — Identity, marital status, family connections
- **Media** — Negative news, court records, public information

No competitor in Africa offers this capability.

$1.7B+ addressable market across Africa

South Africa (Beachhead)

SEGMENT	ANNUAL SPEND	VERIGATE ADDRESSABLE
Banking & Financial Services	R2–4B	**R800M–R1.5B**
Insurance	R1–2B	**R400M–R800M**
Government	R1–3B	**R500M–R1B**
Property & Legal	R500M–R1B	**R200M–R400M**
Telecoms & Retail	R500M–R1B	**R200M–R400M**
Total SA TAM	**R5–11B**	**R2.1–4.1B**

Africa (5-Year Horizon)

$500M+
Nigeria

$400M+
East Africa

$300M+
West Africa

$220M
South Africa

Why Now

POPIA Enforcement is Active
The Information Regulator is investigating and fining. Companies need compliant verification. VeriGate's data-sovereignty architecture is POPIA-native.

Government Digitisation Accelerating
DHA modernisation, SARS eFiling expansion, and integrated service delivery all create demand for cross-agency verification infrastructure.

AfCFTA Needs Cross-Border KYC
The African Continental Free Trade Area requires cross-border KYB/KYC for trade — VeriGate's adapter architecture is designed for this.

SARB Guidance Note 7
New AML/CFT guidance demands multi-source verification that manual processes cannot deliver at scale.

Global identity verification market projected to exceed $21B by 2028

Per-verification pricing. 65–80% gross margin.

Per-Verification Pricing

VERIFICATION TYPE	PRICE / CHECK
Identity (DHA)	**R8–R15**
Company (CIPC)	**R10–R20**
Sanctions Screening	**R5–R10**
Property (DeedsWeb)	**R15–R30**
Document Verification (AI)	**R15–R35**
Full KYC Bundle (5+ checks)	**R40–R80**
Full KYB Bundle (company + directors)	**R60–R120**

Subscription Tiers

TIER	MONTHLY	INCLUDED
Starter	R5,000	500 verifications
Professional	R25,000	3,000 verifications
Enterprise	R75,000+	15,000+ verifications
Government	Custom	Custom + dedicated support

65–80%

GROSS MARGIN PER VERIFICATION

Cost = API fees to source agencies + compute

5:1+

TARGET LTV:CAC RATIO

Enterprise contracts are inherently sticky

Why It's Sticky

Once an enterprise integrates VeriGate's API into its compliance or underwriting workflow, switching is expensive and risky. Verification is embedded in critical business processes — it is not a tool you swap out casually.

Working platform. Not a prototype.

Milestones Achieved

- DONE — Core platform architecture designed and built
- DONE — 10 of 14 verification adapters live
- DONE — Cross-account AWS deployment validated
- DONE — 3 AI modules built and demonstrated
- DONE — Partner portal with visual policy builder shipped
- DONE — Event-driven audit trail operational

- IN PROGRESS — ISO 27001 certification
- IN PROGRESS — NCR registration
- NEXT — First pilot customers

TRL 6–7

Technology Readiness Level

System demonstrated in relevant environment

Co-Investment to Date

R800,000

~€40,000 self-funded • Zero external funding

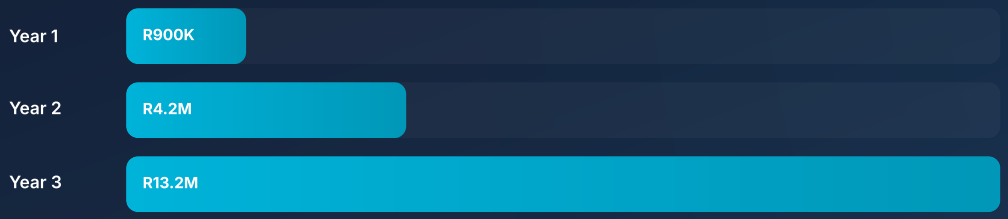
- 12+ months full-time engineering
- AWS infrastructure & testing
- 10 functional adapters + 3 AI modules
- Partner portal design & development

> We have done the hardest part — building a working, enterprise-grade platform with zero external funding.

Path to R13.2M ARR in 3 years

PERIOD	CUSTOMERS	MONTHLY VERIFICATIONS	MRR
Month 6	2–3 pilots	20K–50K	**R80K–R200K**
Month 12	5–8 paying	100K–300K	**R400K–R1.2M**
Month 24	15–25	500K–1.5M	**R2M–R6M**

ARR Growth



Growth Phases

PHASE 1 — MONTHS 1–4

Certification & First Revenue

ISO 27001 certified. NCR registered. First 2 pilot customers onboarded. Unit economics validated.

PHASE 2 — MONTHS 4–8

Commercial Traction

Convert pilots to paid. Land 3–5 additional enterprise customers. Launch self-service API portal for SME market.

PHASE 3 — MONTHS 8–12

Scale & Expansion

10+ paying customers. Nigeria/Kenya adapter scoping. Series A preparation. 2+ system integrator partnerships.

Conservative projections based on enterprise contract values

First mover in unified risk intelligence for Africa

CAPABILITY	VERIGATE	XDS / EXPERIAN	IDENFO / SMILE ID	WORLDCHECK	MANUAL (STATUS QUO)
Multi-source verification (14+ types)	✓	✗	✗	✗	~
Conflict of interest detection	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
AI-powered risk scoring	✓	~	✗	~	✗
Data sovereignty (no central DB)	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓
Real-time (seconds, not days)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗
Pan-African adapter architecture	✓	✗	~	✗	✗
Visual policy builder	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗

Architecture Is the Moat

Cross-account data sovereignty and adapter-based design are extraordinarily difficult to retrofit. VeriGate was designed for this from day one.

Network Effects

Every new data source makes the platform more valuable for every existing customer. Customers naturally expand from 2 checks to 8+ checks.

Switching Costs

Once integrated into compliance workflows, VeriGate becomes embedded in critical business processes. Switching is expensive and risky.

✓ = Full ~ = Partial ✗ = No

€100,000 to reach market.

Go-to-Market €25,000

Enterprise sales capacity, events, collateral

Production Hardening €20,000

Tests, query-side, observability, security

ISO 27001 Certification €15,000

Mandatory for government & banking contracts

Pilot Customer Support €15,000

Onboarding first 2–3 pilot customers

Africa Expansion Research €10,000

Nigeria & Kenya adapter scoping

NCR Registration + Operating €15,000

Credit bureau access + AWS, legal, admin (12 months)

What €100K Unlocks

- **ISO 27001 certified** — opens government and banking market
- **NCR registered** — unlocks credit bureau (14th adapter)
- **Production-hardened** — TRL 8–9
- **2–3 pilot customers** — first revenue
- **Africa expansion groundwork** — Nigeria & Kenya ready

Capital Efficiency

R800K (~€40K) self-invested has produced a working TRL 6–7 platform with 10 adapters and 3 AI modules. €100K from Fuze completes the journey to market. Total pre-revenue investment: ~€140K for a platform targeting a $1.7B market.

VeriGate

The platform is built.
The market is ready.
We need the right partner.

VeriGate is infrastructure that makes every bank, insurer, law firm, and government department in Africa more secure, more compliant, and faster. It makes every startup in the ecosystem that depends on verification more viable.

€100K	14	$1.7B+	TRL 6–7
FUNDING REQUEST	VERIFICATION TYPES	ADDRESSABLE MARKET	WORKING PLATFORM

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